

Pre-Session Setup — *Working With Your Own Data*

A 20-minute checklist to come ready. No code yet — we build it together in the session.

Prepared by **P V Dinesh**, your session mentor — AI Implementation Specialist & Product Leader.

Tonight's job is small: get a couple of accounts and your data ready. **You do not need any code yet** — we share the code and walk through it together during the session. This takes about 20 minutes.

Topic	Working with your own data — RAG, knowledge bases, and structured inputs
Your track	Technical (Python / LangChain) or Non-technical (Flowise) — pick one below
Time needed now	~20 minutes
Session date	Thursday, 11 June 2026 · 3:30–5:00 PM
Office hours	Friday — bring one working query against your own data

We may update this before the session — re-check it the night before.

1. Everyone — do these first

These three matter more than any tool. Get them right and the session works.

- ☐ **Have your REAL data ready, not a sample.** The whole point is connecting AI to *your* business data — a folder of files, an export, or a database dump, whatever your product actually runs on. Just have it on hand; you don't upload anything yet.
- ☐ **Write down ONE real question** your product needs to answer from that data. *Example (PropTech): "What is the new handover date for Tower B and why did it change?"*
- ☐ **Redact anything sensitive.** Remove customer PII, passwords, account numbers. Once data goes into a cloud tool, treat it as no longer private. When in doubt, mask it.

What format should my data be in?

Data type	Examples	Good format to have
Unstructured	emails, PDFs, Word docs, chat logs	<code>.txt</code> / <code>.md</code> / <code>.pdf</code> , or <code>.mbox</code> / <code>.json</code> email export
Semi-structured	spreadsheets, bug DBs, Notion exports	<code>.csv</code> or <code>.json</code> (export Notion as Markdown/JSON)
Structured	ERP, inventory, accounting	a database dump, or confirm you have export/API access

If your data is a database or ERP (not documents), flag it — your path is a little different (we cover this in the session). You still attend and set up normally.

2. Technical track — just two things

Tonight you only need two things ready. On the session day we share the code (a GitHub link), and it installs everything else for you.

- ☐ **Install Python** (version 3.8 or newer) — download from python.org/downloads and run the installer. On Windows, tick "Add Python to PATH" during install.
- ☐ **Get one API key** — pick a provider, sign up, create the key, save it somewhere safe:
 - **OpenRouter** — one key works for Claude, GPT, and open-source models. openrouter.ai/keys (`sk-or-...`). You may need a small amount of credit to run the models — add enough to test.

- **Anthropic** — console.anthropic.com (`sk-ant-...`), or
- **OpenAI** — platform.openai.com (`sk-...`).

Plus your data and one question from Section 1. That is the whole setup.

You are ready (technical) when: Python is installed, your API key is saved, and your data + one question are ready.

3. Non-technical track — Flowise

- ☐ **Create a free Flowise account** and confirm you can log in. Sign up at cloud.flowiseai.com — the **free plan (\$0)** is enough for the session and needs no install. Keep your document small (the free plan has limited storage).
- ☐ **Get one API key** for the answer step — OpenRouter, OpenAI, or Anthropic (same links as above). Keep a small balance on it so it can be tested. You will paste it into a node during the session.
- ☐ **Have your primary document** ready in `.pdf`, `.txt`, or Google Doc export, plus one question.
- ☐ You do **not** build anything beforehand — we share a starter flow and build it together during the session.

You are ready (non-technical) when: you can log into Flowise, your API key is saved, and your document + one question are ready.

4. Quick self-check

- ☐ I know which track I am on (technical or Flowise).
- ☐ My real data is ready, in a sensible format, with sensitive parts removed.
- ☐ I have written down one real question.
- ☐ I have an API key saved.
- ☐ (Technical) Python is installed on my machine.
- ☐ (Flowise) My instance is running and I can log in.

On the day — what to expect

- ☐ **Technical:** we share the code via a GitHub link and run it on your machine together. The code installs the libraries it needs, then you paste your API key, drop in your data, and ask your question — live.
- ☐ **Non-technical:** we share a Flowise starter flow and build it together, then you load your document and ask your question.

Nothing to download or run before then. Just come ready with the accounts and data above.

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